

Sam Altman a 'sociopath'

Bombshell report claims lack of trust in OpenAI CEO

—By **Jayesh Shinde**

On the surface, Sam Altman appears to be this hot shot poster boy of GenAI, ever since ChatGPT captured everyone's imagination in late 2022. He's the guy cutting multi-billion dollar deals, from Microsoft to Stargate, pushing AI down everyone's throats. All the while smiling, waving, basking in the glitz and glory of being one of the key architects of AI's broad

adoption curve around the world – much to Elon Musk's chagrin, with whom Altman is in a very public feud.

on secret memos put together by Ilya Sutskever, former chief scientist at OpenAI, and over 200 pages of notes from Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei, who was OpenAI's former safety lead.

"Lying" is the first word Sutskever used to describe Sam Altman's consistent pattern of behaviour, in one of his memos. This sentiment was echoed by Amodei, according to his private notes from his time working under Sam Altman, writing, "The problem with OpenAI is Sam himself."

former colleagues and industry figures, created an environment where trust became difficult to maintain.

Aaron Swartz, who knew Altman from their time at Y Combinator, is cited as having expressed deep distrust in him. Former OpenAI board member Sue Yoon also questioned Altman's decision-making, suggesting that some of his actions seemed disconnected from practical reality.

These concerns are not purely anecdotal. They connect directly to a major turning point in OpenAI's history. In 2023, Altman was briefly removed as CEO after the board stated he had not been "consistently candid" in his communications, leading to a breakdown in trust. The board, which included Sutskever, cited concerns around transparency, particularly on issues related to AI safety and governance.

Altman's return just five days later reshaped the company's leadership. Several board members who supported his removal stepped down, and the current board is more aligned with him.

The report also raises broader concerns about OpenAI's direction. Originally founded with a strong emphasis on safety and openness, the organisation has since moved toward a more commercial model. Critics cited in the investigation argue that safety teams have been scaled back and that the company's original charter may no longer meaningfully guide its decisions.

Taken together, the findings paint a complicated and often troubling picture. While there are always multiple perspectives in any such account, the report leaves open a larger question: as AI becomes more powerful and influential, can its development be trusted in the hands of leaders whose judgment and transparency are being publicly questioned. tinyurl.com/d27usza



Turns out, Musk wasn't totally unhinged in all his public attacks on Altman – largely restricted to his X.com feed. A new bombshell piece by the New Yorker is raising serious questions about Sam Altman's character, competence and temperament, based on more than a hundred interviews conducted with industry insiders over the past year.

The question being asked is whether Sam Altman is worthy of our trust? Should we, as users, follow him blindly as the Pied Piper of all things AI? The New Yorker investigation is based

According to the New Yorker report, one tech executive called Sam Altman as being "unbelievably persuasive" to the level of playing Jedi mind tricks.

According to the New Yorker report, quoting multiple tech executives and former OpenAI employees, Sam Altman is described as an unapologetic liar and an expert manipulator of people ensuring they bend to his will.

A particularly revealing characterisation quoted in the report describes Altman as having two conflicting traits: a strong desire to be liked and an apparent lack of concern for the consequences of misleading others. This combination, according to several